MCKINNEY-VENTO PD · DURING THE VIDEO

Notice · Refer · Protect

Name / School: _____

While you watch, jot at least one idea in each column. You'll use these notes in the group activities.

Notice

Signs I might see in my classroom, office or hallway

Refer

Who I would tell, and how quickly

Protect

What I must keep private, and what must never become a barrier

City Schools McKinney-Vento Liaison: 443-642-2424 · My school's McKinney-Vento liaison: _____

AGREE

Activity 1 · Agree / Disagree Line-Up

DISAGREE

Activity 1 · Agree / Disagree Line-Up

ACTIVITY 2 · BEFORE THE VIDEO

Guess the Number

✂ Cut along the dashed lines. One slip per table.

Table guess

How many Maryland students were identified as experiencing homelessness in 2023–24?

How many of them were in Baltimore City?

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How many of them were in Baltimore City?

ACTIVITY 4 · AFTER THE VIDEO

Who Qualifies? Sorting Mat

Place each scenario card in a column. Remember: staff don't decide eligibility; the McKinney-Vento liaison does. **When in doubt, refer.**

Likely eligible

Refer to the McKinney-Vento liaison

Not enough information

Refer, and let the liaison decide

Likely not eligible

Fixed, regular and adequate housing

Discuss

Which cards caused the most debate? Why is "refer when unsure" the safest rule?

✂ Activity 4 · Who Qualifies? Scenario cards: cut along the dashed lines

1 SCENARIO

Maya's family lost their apartment after a fire. They're staying in a relative's basement.

2 SCENARIO

Andre's family lives in a motel because they can't afford a deposit on an apartment.

3 SCENARIO

Jasmine, 17, left home after conflict with her parents and is sleeping at friends' houses.

4 SCENARIO

The Lee family sold their house and is renting while their new home is built.

5 SCENARIO

Carlos and his mom sleep in their car some nights and at a shelter on others.

6 SCENARIO

Tiana's family moved in with her grandmother. Tiana mentions "we had to leave our old place."

7 SCENARIO

A newly enrolled student has no records and says they're "staying with people."

8 SCENARIO

Jordan lives in a trailer with no running water or electricity.

9 SCENARIO

Ethan's family sold their home and is temporarily staying in a furnished short-term rental while waiting to close on a new house.

10 SCENARIO

Sophia and her younger brother recently moved in with their aunt after leaving their previous residence.

✂ Activity 5 · Barrier Busters: one card per table

1 BARRIER

The front office tells a mother her son can't start until she brings a lease and immunization records.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

2 BARRIER

A student who moved to a shelter across town has missed four days because there's no way to get to school.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

3 BARRIER

A student can't go on a field trip because the $25 fee is overdue.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

4 BARRIER

A student keeps getting sent to the office for not wearing a uniform.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

5 BARRIER

A family and the school disagree about whether the student qualifies. The school says the student must stay home until it's resolved.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

6 BARRIER

A student hasn't eaten breakfast because the family hasn't filled out a meal form.

Right at stake:

What should happen:

Who we contact:

1 CASE

Ms. Rivera enrolls her daughter, who has an IEP from another state, after the family's apartment was condemned. The family is at a shelter. The student has had no special education services for three weeks.

2 CASE

Kwame, 9, arrived from Ghana with his father. They're staying with a church member's family. His father speaks Twi and limited English and has no school records.

3 CASE

Destiny, a senior, has been staying with friends since her mother's eviction. She wants to apply for college financial aid but can't get her parent's information.

4 CASE

Malik, 7, comes to school hungry, with untreated tooth pain, and says he's living in "the car with Mom." He mentions an adult at the car hurts him when Mom isn't there.

5 CASE

The Thompson children (pre-K, 2nd grade and 6th grade) moved to a motel near the county line. The pre-K child lost her spot, and the two older siblings have missed a week.

6 CASE

Aaliyah, 15, is doubled up with a relative. She's withdrawn, says she "doesn't see the point anymore," and has stopped turning in work.

7 CASE

Jayden, a junior, moved to a shelter mid-semester. He's on the varsity basketball team, is two credits behind, and was told his partial coursework from his old school "doesn't count."

8 CASE

A family of four shows up at the front office the morning after losing their housing. The children have no immunization records and the parent is worried about being reported.

ACTIVITY 5B · AFTER THE VIDEO

Who Else Needs to Know?

Case #: _____ Table: _____

Circle every department this case needs. The McKinney-Vento liaison coordinates, but others act too. Share only the information each office needs; housing status is confidential.

- McKinney-Vento liaison
- Counselor / social worker
- Special education / IEP team
- ESOL / English learner office
- School nurse / health services
- Transportation
- Food and nutrition services
- Attendance
- Child Protective Services (mandated report)
- School psychologist / behavioral health
- Early childhood / Pre-K
- College and career / financial aid
- Athletics and activities
- Registrar / enrollment

Who acts first?

Name the office and the first action. Is anything required today?

Who else, and what do they do?

List each department and its role

What does each office need to know?

Minimum information only

Where could the hand-off break down?

And how will we prevent it?

✂ Activity 6 · The Right Words: one set per group of three. Rotate roles for each scenario.

A ROLE-PLAY

A usually on-time 4th grader has been late all week, falling asleep in class, and wearing the same clothes.

B ROLE-PLAY

A 10th grader mentions they've been "couch surfing" and asks you not to tell anyone.

C ROLE-PLAY

A parent at pickup says they're "between places right now" and worried about their child changing schools.

Observer checklist

- [ ] Spoke privately, not in front of others
- [ ] Used neutral words ("Where are you staying right now?") rather than "Are you homeless?"
- [ ] Didn't promise secrecy they can't keep, but explained that information is shared only with people who can help
- [ ] Named the next step: the school's McKinney-Vento liaison
- [ ] Didn't make the student or family prove anything

Phrases that worked

ACTIVITY 7 · CLOSING

Our School Action Map

School: _____

1. Our McKinney-Vento liaison

Name, room, extension. Citywide line: 443-642-2424

2. Where students might be noticed

Front office, attendance, nurse, cafeteria, buses, coaches...

3. Our referral steps

Who tells whom, how quickly, and how it stays confidential

4. One barrier we'll remove this month

Uniform closet, grab-and-go breakfast, front-office enrollment script...

3-2-1 Exit Ticket

3 signs a student might be experiencing homelessness

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

2 rights a student has under McKinney-Vento

1 _____

2 _____

1 person at my school I'll contact

1 _____

3-2-1 Exit Ticket

3 signs a student might be experiencing homelessness

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

2 rights a student has under McKinney-Vento

1 _____

2 _____

1 person at my school I'll contact

1 _____

3-2-1 Exit Ticket

3 signs a student might be experiencing homelessness

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

2 rights a student has under McKinney-Vento

1 _____

2 _____

1 person at my school I'll contact

1 _____

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Answer Key

Activity 1 · Agree / Disagree statements

Statement	Answer
1. A student living with their aunt's family because they were evicted counts as homeless under federal law.	Agree: doubled up because of lost housing
2. A school can wait to enroll a student until the family brings proof of address.	Disagree: enrollment is immediate, even without records
3. A student who moves to a shelter across the city has to change schools.	Disagree: can stay in school of origin when in their best interest, with transportation
4. Teachers should tell the class when a student is homeless, so classmates can help.	Disagree: housing status is confidential
5. A 16-year-old living on their own, without a parent, can enroll themselves in school.	Agree: unaccompanied youth are covered and enrolled right away

Activity 2 · Guess the Number

20,402 statewide; 5,732 in Baltimore City (MSDE, 2023–24). That's more than 1 in 4 of the state total and about 1 in 13 City Schools students, or about 38 students in a school of 500.

Activity 4 · Who Qualifies?

Likely eligible	Not enough information: refer	Likely not eligible
1 (doubled up after fire), 2 (motel, no alternative), 3 (unaccompanied youth), 5 (car and shelter), 8 (inadequate housing)	6 (reason for the move matters), 7 (needs a private conversation with the liaison), 10 (potentially doubled up: more information is needed to know whether the move resulted from loss of housing, economic hardship, safety concerns, or another qualifying situation)	4 (planned move, fixed and adequate housing), 9 (not eligible: although temporary, the housing is planned and adequate, not caused by loss of housing, economic hardship, or a similar reason)

Activity 5 · Barrier Busters

#	Right at stake → what should happen
1	Immediate enrollment without records; the liaison helps get them afterward
2	School of origin with transportation; call the McKinney-Vento liaison right away
3	Full access to activities; fee waivers through the McKinney-Vento Program
4	Uniforms and clothing are available through the program; don't discipline for what the student can't control
5	Student is enrolled and attends while the dispute is resolved
6	Automatic eligibility for free meals; no form needed

Sources: 42 U.S.C. §§ 11431–11435 and § 1758(b)(12); MSDE Homeless Education Trend Data 2018–2024. Full list in SOURCES.md.

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Answer Key: Who Else Needs to Know?

Case	Departments	First step and key points
1	McKinney-Vento liaison, special education / IEP team, transportation	Enroll immediately and provide services comparable to the existing IEP right away; the liaison and IEP team coordinate records and transportation to the school of origin if that's in the student's best interest.
2	McKinney-Vento liaison, ESOL office, registrar, nurse	Enroll immediately without records; interpreter for the father; ESOL screening; the liaison helps obtain records and immunizations.
3	McKinney-Vento liaison, counselor, college and career / financial aid	The liaison can verify Destiny is an unaccompanied homeless youth, so she can apply for financial aid as an independent student without her parent's information.
4	Child Protective Services (mandated report), McKinney-Vento liaison, nurse, food services, counselor / social worker	The disclosure of harm requires a mandated report today. Living in a car is not, by itself, neglect; the report is about the abuse. Meet basic needs: meals, dental referral, and the liaison connects the family to shelter and services.
5	McKinney-Vento liaison, early childhood / Pre-K, transportation, attendance	School of origin with transportation if in each child's best interest; restore the pre-K placement (preschoolers are covered); attendance supports, not penalties.
6	Counselor / social worker, school psychologist / behavioral health, McKinney-Vento liaison	"Doesn't see the point" may signal suicide risk: follow the school's crisis protocol the same day, then ongoing support and removal of academic barriers.
7	McKinney-Vento liaison, registrar / counselor, athletics	Procedures must exist to award partial credit for work done at the previous school; work with athletics to remove barriers to staying on the team; transportation to school of origin if in his best interest.
8	Registrar / front office, McKinney-Vento liaison, nurse, food services	Enroll the same day without immunization records; liaison and nurse help get records; free meals start right away. Losing housing is not a reason for a report; keep the situation confidential.

Close the activity by asking: "Where do hand-offs between offices usually break down at our school?"